

The Right-Way Wrong-Way Bridge

Presented By

The Cambridge Historical Society

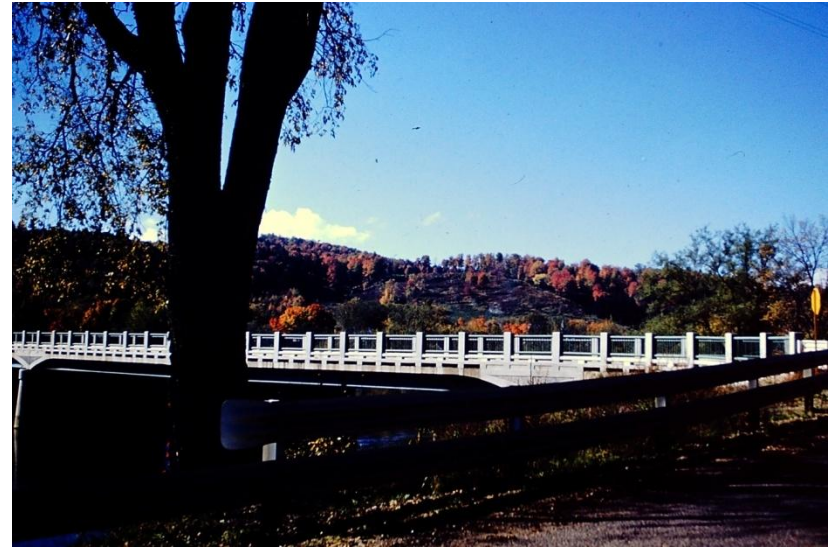
49 School Street

Jeffersonville, Vermont 05464



Preserving the past. Looking to the future.

The Right-Way Wrong-Way Bridge

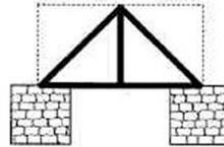


The Truss Bridge

Kingpost Truss

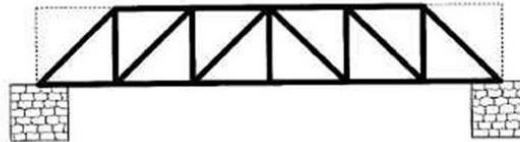
Oldest truss design

Short spans to 30 feet



Multiple Kingpost Truss

Longer Spans to 100 feet

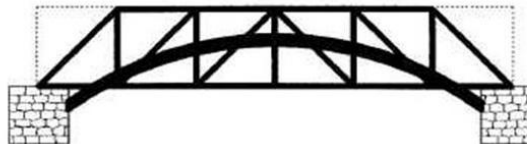


Burr Arch Truss

Has an arch for added strength and stability

Spans can exceed 100'

Theodore Burr credited with this design (Patented April 3, 1817)



The Burr Truss



The "Double-Barreled" Covered Bridge at Cambridge Boro



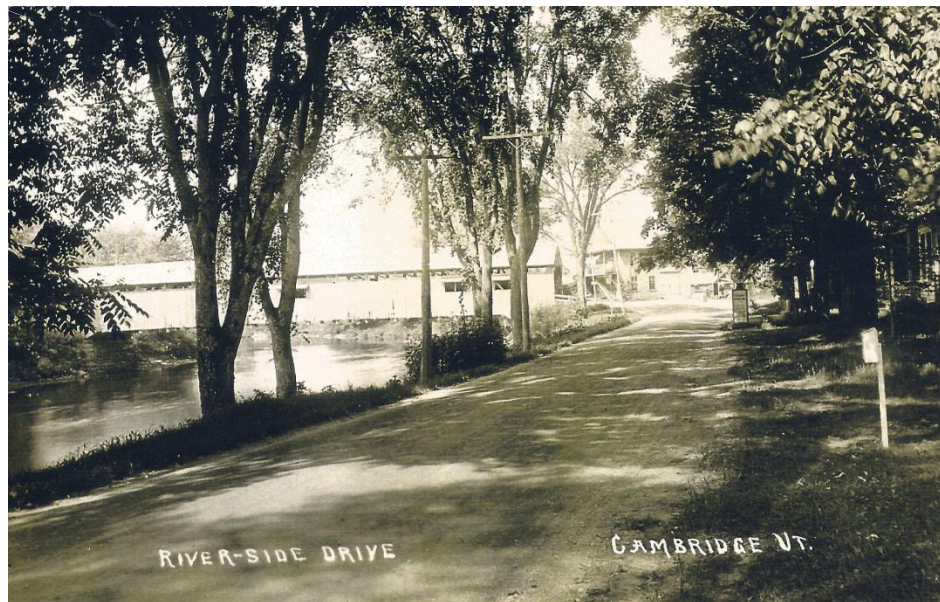
Called "Big Bridge"
168' long, Burr Arch Truss
Built 1845 by George W. Holmes
Replaced a ferry/old bridge

The “Double-Barreled” Covered Bridge at Cambridge Boro



Covered bridge in Cambridge, built in 1845. It was moved in 1949. There was a foot bridge on right and store in background. Photo taken 1930s.

River Road in Cambridge Boro



The Single Lane Covered Bridge at Cambridge Boro

“Little Bridge.”

“Gates Bridge”

Built 1897

Builder: G. W. Holmes

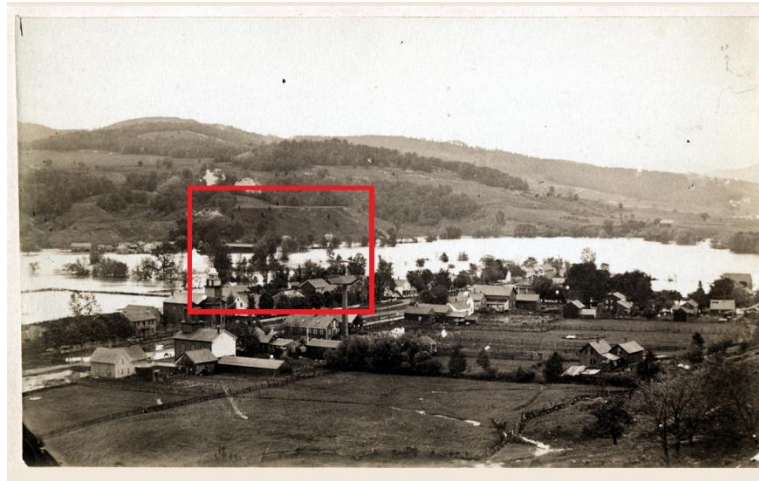


82.5' long

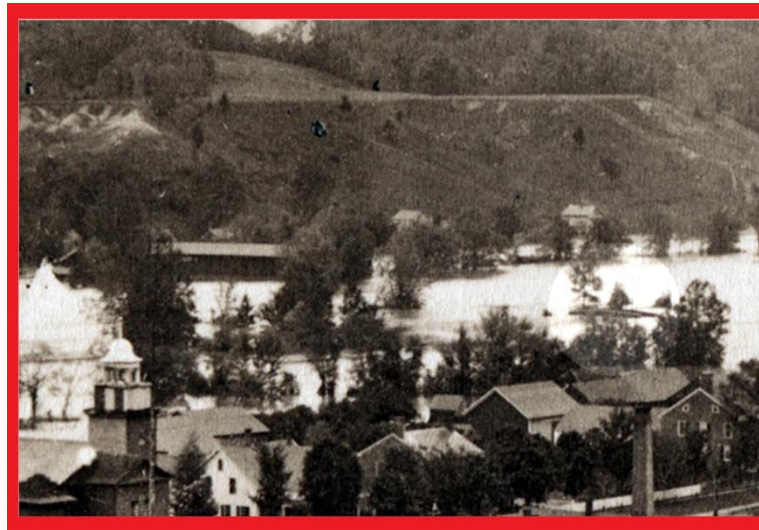
Burr Arch Truss

Replaced a plank bridge

Lamoille Flooding – Oct. 5, 1869



Plank bridge over the Seymour River (highlighted)



Lamoille Flooding - 1927

Flood waters reached 7' high inside the bridge



Flood waters at the 7' high level mark on the bridge



Lamoille Flooding



Gates' Bridge – 1927

Was moved 20' from its original location

Circa 1940



WWB – Myth

Myth

- The road was reoriented to accommodate improperly manufactured bridge girders
- Some draftsman copied the blueprint wrong
- An off-site deskbound engineer pulled out a bridge plan with a standard curve of the correct degree, but drew it the wrong way on the plans
- Build a road straight off the bridge end, up the hill to Jeffersonville to avoid Spring floods on Rt. 15
- The road bends oddly because the supervisor of highways at the time lived in St. Albans

WWB – Reality: The Building Project

Reality

The bridge was built correctly as part of a post WWII plan to rearrange the highway between the villages of Cambridge and Jeffersonville.

The Four Part Plan:

1. Move Rt. 15 from Jeffersonville's Main Street to someplace westerly
2. Relocate Seymour Brook to join the Lamoille farther upstream of the existing two lane covered bridge in Cambridge
3. Replace both covered bridges in Cambridge with one steel bridge
4. Relocate Rt. 15 behind Cambridge Village on the abandoned roadbed of the Burlington & Lamoille Railroad R.O.W.

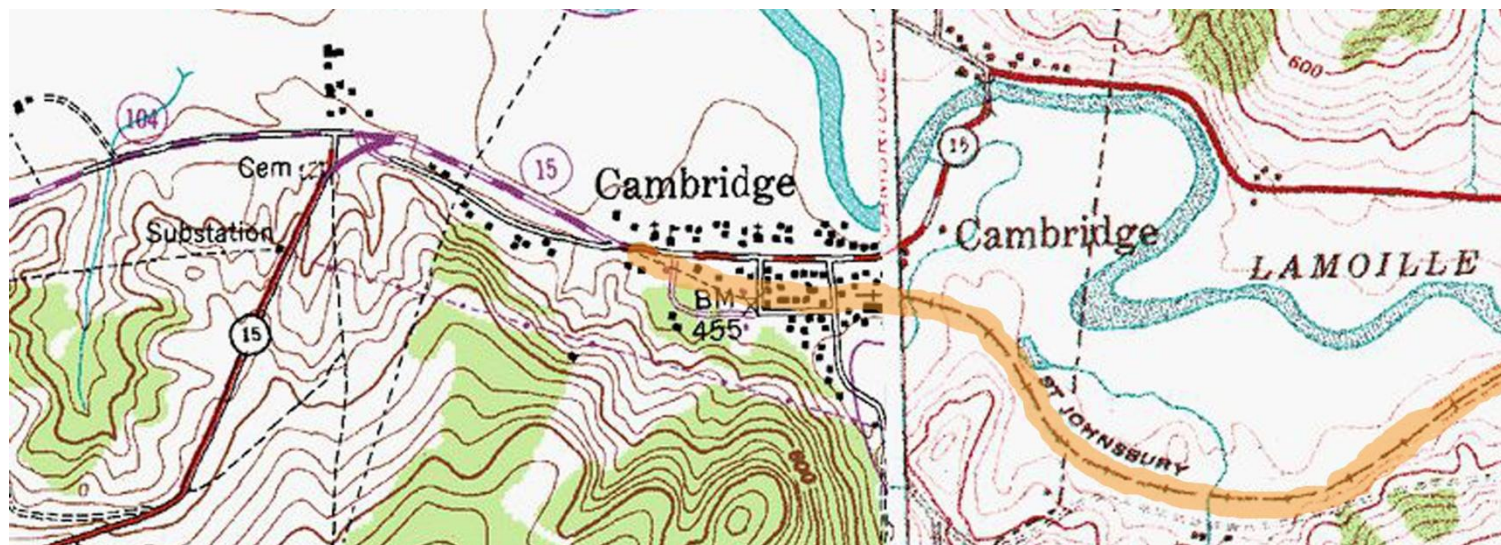
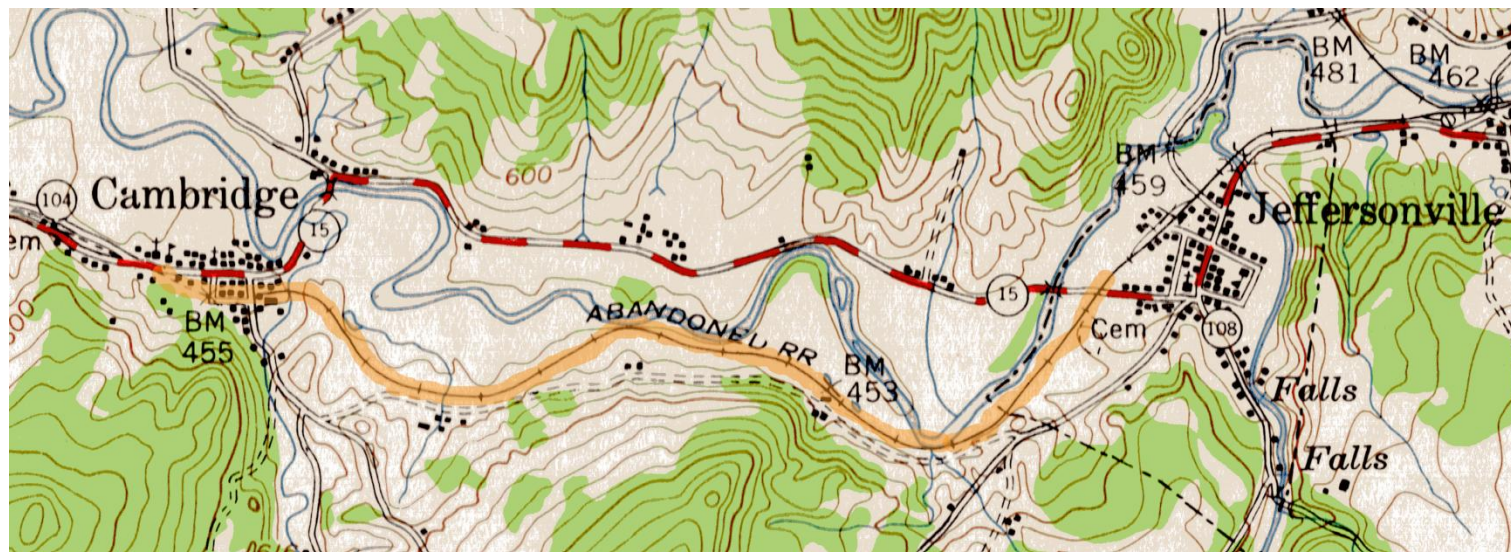
WWB – The Project's Results

The Three Part Results:

1. The Jeffersonville bypass was built
2. The entrance of the Seymour River on the Lamoille River was moved upstream.
3. Cambridge's two covered bridges were moved and replaced with a steel and concrete bridge

Route 15 was never relocated to the abandoned Burlington & Lamoille Railroad R.O.W.

WWB – Proposed Rt. 15 Reroute



Building of the WWB 1949-1950



Building of the WWB



Building of the WWB



Disassembling the "Double-Barreled" Covered Bridge



Disassembling the "Double-Barreled" Covered Bridge



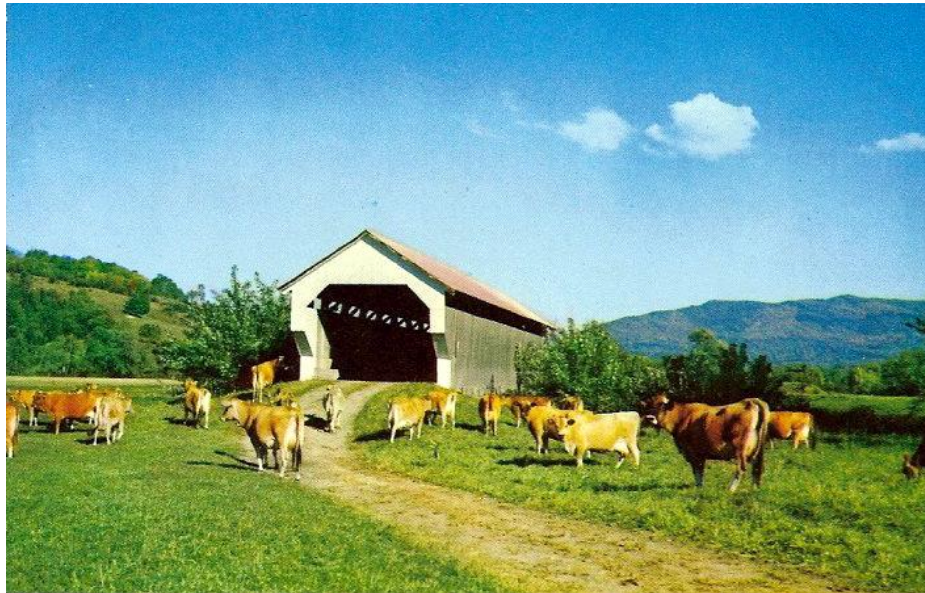
The WWB Completed



Gates Bridge Relocation



Gates Bridge Relocation



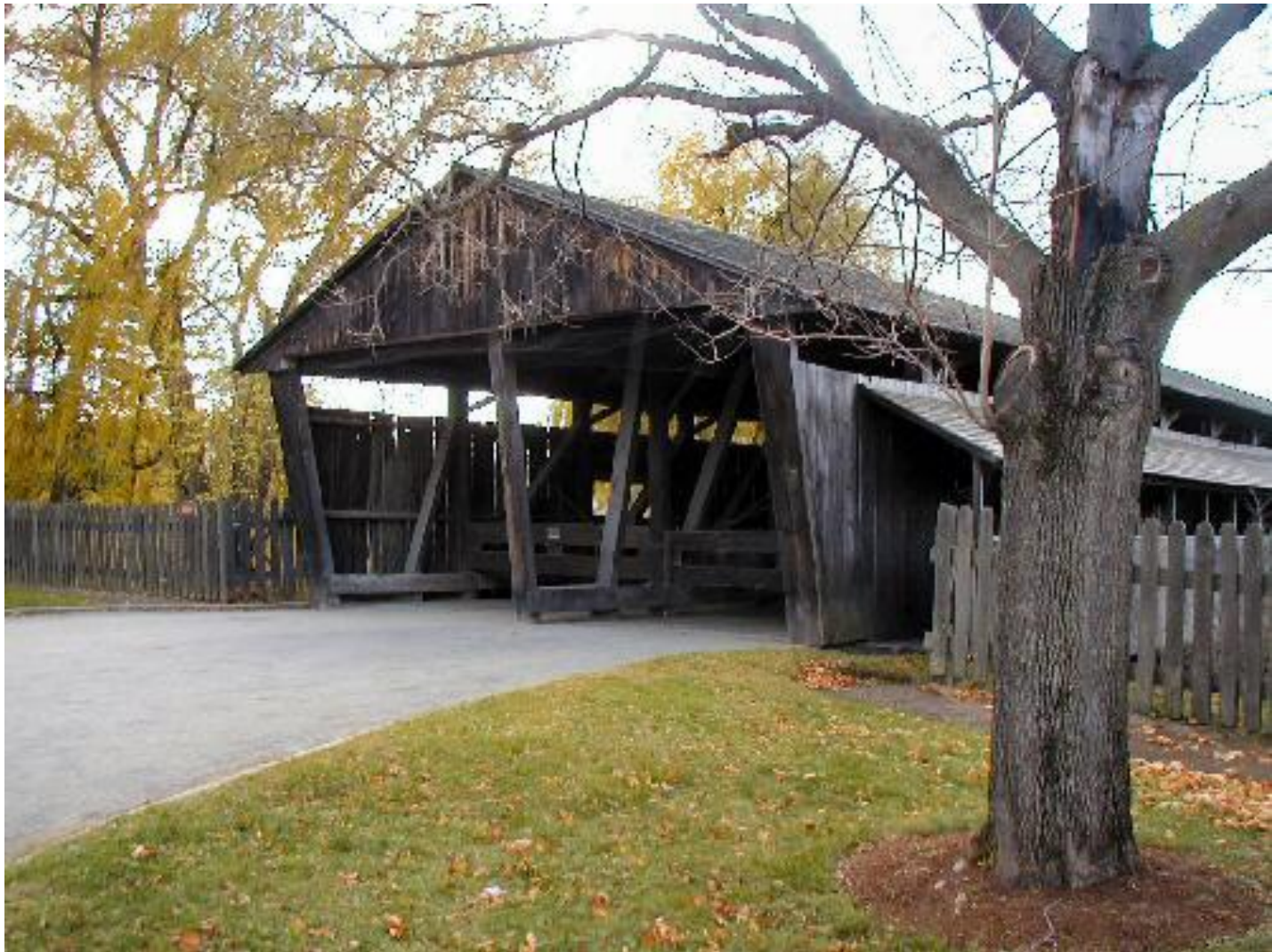
Rebuilding at Shelburne Museum 1950-1951



Rebuilding at Shelburne Museum



Shelburne Museum



The Right-Way Wrong-Way Bridge



Acknowledgements & References

- Unidentified maker, *Reassembly of the Cambridge Covered Bridge*, 1951-1952. Gelatin silver print, 8x10 in. Collection of Shelburne Museum Archives. PS4.10-79.
 - Unidentified maker, *Reassembly of the Cambridge Covered Bridge*, 1951-1952. Gelatin silver print, 8x10 in. Collection of Shelburne Museum Archives. PS4.10-63.
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 - Cambridge Historical Society Photo Collection
 - Stub Wells Photo Collection
 - Harold Putnam Photo Collection
 - Clark Dodge Photo Collection
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 - The Bridger, VCBS, Winter 2006, *Wrong-Way Bridge, A Museum Treasure, and an Unused Rail Bed*, Bob Moore (an ex-steel bridger)
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Cambridge's Other Double Lane Covered Bridge



Cambridge's Other Double Lane Covered Bridge In Jeffersonville



Cambridge Historical Society

Cambridge, Vermont
Gateway to Smugglers' Notch

HOME

UPCOMING EVENTS

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THE HARKENER NEWSLETTER

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A LOOK AT THE PAST

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The Cambridge Historical Society, located in Cambridge Vermont, is dedicated to studying and preserving the history of our small part of the world. Located just over the mountain from Stowe, Cambridge is proud of its commitment to its heritage. We meet every 2nd Wednesday of the month at the Warner Lodge, 49 School St., Jeffersonville, VT

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